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UNIVERSITY OF PRETORIA
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Faculty of Engineering, Built Environment and
Information Technology

EPE 321

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING

PROJECT PROPOSAL

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I. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Many job seekers find the application process tedious, frustrating, and time-consuming. This is because jobs are scattered across multiple platforms where each requiring lengthy and repetitive forms. This leaves the people seeking jobs feeling frustrated and often trying to look for other ways to apply for jobs. With 32.9% [1] of South Africans unemployed as well as approximately 220 000 [2] people graduating from South African universities every year, the demand for jobs continues to rise creating a growing need for a job application solution.

This application will bring a new experience to the job application market making job applications easier than ever. With a modern and user friendly approach, the application will adopt a dating app style application. This means users will only have to swipe left and right on potential jobs and then rest will be handled by the application. The users will only have to input their information and CV once when they sign up and the app will do the rest of the administrative work automatically. This will also make a much better user experience for employers as all the job applications will be in one place where everything will be easy and simple to manage. This application will provide a simple and easy way for people to apply for jobs without long monotonous forms and spending long hours searching for job applications. The application will provide a high quality user experience that reduces time spent on applications and will solve the large problem that job seekers have today.

II. USER STORIES AND PRIORITISATION

From the employee side of the application, the employee will sign up to the web application where they will be met with a few forms to fill out all their information needed as well as to attach a CV. Once this information is received, the user will be directed to the home page where it will get a view of a potential job which they meet the requirements for. This view will look the same as a dating website, only instead of people, the user will be viewing jobs. The user can then swipe left to decline the job or right to apply for the job. If the user swipes right, their application will be sent to the job where the job will have the choice of what the next step is (i.e. setting up a meeting, messaging the user or declining the job application. The user will also have a messaging page where they can respond to any messages sent to them by the employers.

On the employers side of the application, the employers will sign up and fill out any necessary information needed. Once the information is received, they will be redirected to their home page which will show current job listings (if available, otherwise it will give them the option to make job listings) and the user will be able to click on any job listing and see if all the applicants. From there the user can either message or remove the applicant.

III. ENSURING CLIENT AND END-USER SATISFACTION THROUGH AGILE DEVELOPMENT

To ensure client and end-user satisfaction, the agile development methodology will be adopted. This allows for a collaborative approach with continuous feedback. Instead of the client receiving a product all at once, the product will be build over short development cycles where the client will be updated on whats going on and will be able to make small changes as the application is being developed. Meeting, progress updates and demos will be done on a regular basis to ensure the client is getting the product they want and are able to make any changes they would like as things are developed. This will ensure the client gets the product they wanted while also allowing the development team to stay on schedule to deliver the product when it has been planned to be finished.

IV. FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY CLIENT REQUIREMENTS

Who is this apps target audience?

The target audience is mainly employers looking to hire new people as well as anyone unemployed and looking for a job. This application can also be used for people looking for freelance work however the main purpose of the application is for people looking for jobs.

Will the job seeker have access to all the job applications and if so, how will they find the jobs that they are looking for?

The application will use the requirements set up by the employers when they set up their job listings and only show those job listings to users who match those credentials. For example, if the job applications requires a matric certificate, only users who have a matric certificate will see the job listing on their feed. On top of that, the user will have more control over the jobs by having filters to see the job applications that they want to see such as jobs paying over a certain amount or jobs in a certain area.

What information will the employer see when a user swipes right on their application?

The employer will have certain options of what information they would like namely: user details such as their name, age, qualifications, etc. as well as the users CV. The employee will be able to select what information they would like to receive when creating a job listing and will only receive the relevant information for that listing.

What success metrics will be used?

Businesses will be ranked on how many successful hires they have made. The more hires made, the more likely it is for the business to be at the top of the users feed. The less hires the business has made, the lower on the feed they will appear. This will promote businesses to constantly engage on the platform and look through new applications constantly.

V. UNREASONABLE REQUIREMENTS AND PROPOSED ALTERNATIVES

The app must guarantee job matches and hires for users

No app will be able to guarantee this as it is almost impossible. Interviews, work culture fit and what the employer is looking for all play a role in if the job seeker is hired and thus, it is almost impossible to guarantee job matches. Alternatively, the application will optimize the user experience on both ends to ensure everything possible is done to get job seekers to be hired and job listings to be filled.

Creating a video call service for meetings

This would be an unreasonable requirement as this service is a large enough service to be an application by itself. The resources required would make the project exponentially larger and thus a much better alternative would be to just use an existing platform such as Zoom, Google Meet, Microsoft Teams, etc. and share the joining link through the messaging system the application will provide.

The app will provide a CV builder

This would be outside of the MVP (minimum viable product) and will take many resources as well as a lot of time to build. This would increase the project requirements as well as project resources drastically. Alternatively, users can use free or paid websites or applications such as Canva to build their CV and then upload their CV to this web app.

REFERENCES

- [1] Statistics South Africa, “Quarterly labour force survey (qlfs) – q1: 2025,” May 2025, accessed: 2025-08-04. [Online]. Available: <https://www.gov.za/news/media-statements/statistics-south-africa-quarterly-labour-force-survey-qlfs-%E2%80%93-q1-2025-13-may#:~:text=The%20official%20unemployment%20rate%20was,force%20during%20the%20same%20period.>
- [2] The Citizen (South Africa), “Here’s the latest number of graduates from south africa’s public universities,” <https://www.citizen.co.za/news/south-africa/education/heres-the-latest-number-of-graduates-from-south-africas-public-universities/>, Mar. 2025, accessed: 2025-08-04.